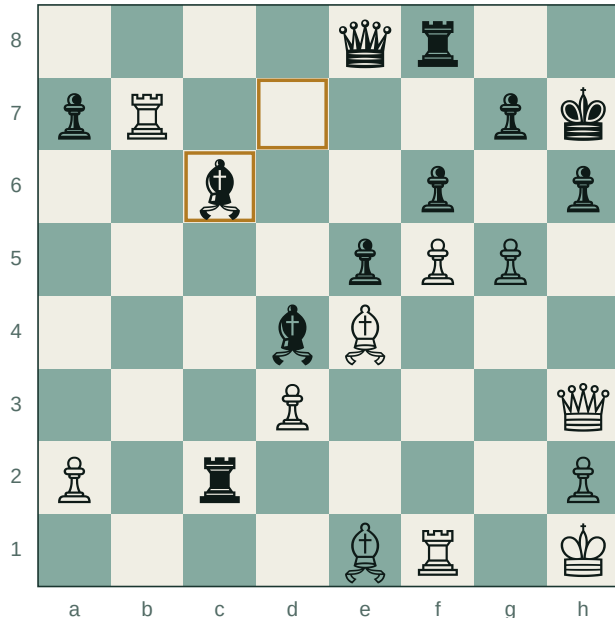


Mate in two: White, move 25

Mate in two

White to move



Previous move: 24...Bc6. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

25. Qxh6+ Kg8 26. Qxg7#

25.Qxh6+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the pawn on h6. Recorded reply: **25...Kg8**.

26.Qxg7# Mate: queen on g7 gives check; Black has no legal reply.

The line ends in checkmate against the king on g8. Material gain is unnecessary once no legal defense exists.

CHECKPOINT

Which piece delivers the final check, and why can the defender not continue? **Answer:** Queen on g7. The king is in check and the position has zero legal replies.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

The displayed line is one recorded defense. Test other legal replies instead of assuming the defender must copy it.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

A mating combination must survive the defender's reply. The first move should force a position in which a second move ends the game against every defense.

HOW TO LOOK

Identify the likely mating square and the defender that prevents it. Calculate the forcing move that removes that resource.

The defending king is on h7. Absolute pin: pawn on g7 and pawn on h6.